E-tiGo — Phase 2 Decisions: Quick Reference

Prepared by: Engineering Team
Date: 16 October 2026
Updated: 18 October 2026 (OQ-36 and OQ-37, Lost & Found, added)
Status: Recommendations for the open Phase 2 questions (OQ-18 to OQ-22, OQ-36 and OQ-37). **None has been confirmed by the client yet.** We ask the client to confirm each one or pick another option **before the Phase 2 build starts (Week 9)**. If there is no answer by then, engineering builds to the recommended defaults: every rule is a setting operations can change later without a release, so this locks nothing in. There are two exceptions. OQ-22: **no new city goes live without a launch date from the client.** OQ-36: **no return fee is charged until the client sets one.**

Executive Summary

Phase 2 had five open questions that blocked building third-party bookings, vehicle maintenance, driver scheduling, dispute escalation and new cities. For each one, this report gives the recommended answer, other options the client can pick instead, and the edge cases we have planned for.

The recommendations follow two principles:

- **Industry practice.** We follow what Uber, Bolt and DoorDash do where their approach is public, adjusted for Nigeria.
- **Flexibility.** Each answer is a setting with a safe default, not a hard-coded rule. Operations can change it as E-tiGo learns.

#	Question	Recommended answer	Client decision needed
OQ-18	Who gets the PIN and live tracking when someone books for another person?	**Both** the rider (by WhatsApp/SMS with a tracking link) and the booker (in the app)	Confirm, or pick rider-only / booker-only
OQ-19	Vehicle maintenance: EV-only, general, or both?	**Both**: general maintenance for every vehicle, plus EV items for plug-in vehicles	Confirm the service intervals
OQ-20	Driver shifts or availability planning?	**Availability planning** for all drivers (voluntary); **shifts** only for E-tiGo fleet cars shared between drivers	Confirm; say which fleet cars are shared
OQ-21	Dispute escalation tiers and owners?	**3 tiers**: Support → Support Lead → Super Admin, with safety cases going straight to the Safety team	Confirm the refund limits per tier
OQ-22	Which cities, and when?	**Abuja next, then Port Harcourt**, each launched only when it passes a readiness checklist	**Client must give the target dates**
OQ-36	Lost & Found: should passengers pay a return fee?	**Yes, ₦2,000**, all of it to the driver (Uber/Bolt practice). Built **off** until the client decides	Confirm the amount, or no fee
OQ-37	Lost & Found: do passenger and driver see each other's number?	**Yes**, once the driver has the item; messages in the app also work	Confirm, or messages only

Scheduled rides and third-party bookings are built. Lost & Found was built on 18 October 2026 to the defaults in OQ-36 and OQ-37 below. Their decisions (SR-1 to SR-7) are in the Scheduled Rides Decisions Report.

OQ-18 — Third-Party Bookings: Who Gets the PIN and Tracking?

A passenger (the **booker**) books and pays for a ride for someone else (the **rider**), such as a parent, child, guest or colleague. Bolt reports that **2–6% of its rides** are already booked for someone else, usually informally.

Industry practice. On Uber, the rider gets a text with the driver's details and a link to follow the driver, and the booker can follow the trip in their own app. The rider does not need the app.

Recommendation

> **PIN: both. Tracking: both.**
>
> - The **rider** gets a WhatsApp message (SMS if WhatsApp fails) when a driver is assigned. It contains the booker's first name, the driver's name, photo, car and plate, the **ride PIN**, and a **live tracking link** that works without the app.
> - The **booker** sees the same PIN and live map in their app, so they can pass the PIN on if the rider's message doesn't arrive.
> - Operations can change either setting to rider only or booker only.

Why both: the person getting into the car must say the PIN, so the rider needs it. Phones in Nigeria are often off, out of data or on a different number, so the booker needs a copy as a fallback. The booker paid for the trip and is responsible for the rider, so seeing the PIN carries no real risk.

Quick options

Option	PIN goes to	Tracking goes to	When to choose it
A (recommended)	Rider + booker	Rider + booker	Fewest failed pickups; best for families and guests
B	Rider only	Rider + booker	If the client wants the strictest PIN control
C	Booker only	Booker only	Cheapest (no messages to the rider); the booker must phone the rider

Edge cases and how we handle them

Situation	What happens
The rider's message fails to deliver (WhatsApp and SMS both fail)	The booker is alerted in the app and shown the PIN **whatever the setting**, so the ride can still start
The rider's number is the booker's own number	Treated as a normal ride, not a third-party one
The rider already has an E-tiGo account	Still messaged by WhatsApp/SMS. We never tell the booker whether a number has an account (privacy). The trip stays in the booker's history
Who pays	The **booker** pays, by **wallet or card only** by default. Cash and bank transfer are off, because the payer is not in the car. Operations can turn cash on
The booker wants their own ride at the same time	Allowed. A third-party ride does not count as the booker's active ride. Limit: **2 active third-party rides** per booker
Scheduled third-party ride	Allowed. The rider gets a reminder 60 minutes before pickup. The PIN is sent at dispatch, as for every scheduled ride

Situation	What happens
The driver needs to call the rider	The driver sees the rider's first name and can call the rider's number while the trip is active, as with a normal passenger
Safety	The tracking page shows the driver, car and plate, a "Call 112" button and the E-tiGo safety line. The booker's in-app SOS works for the rider's trip and gives the Safety team the rider's number
The booker changes the PIN	The new PIN is sent to the rider again
Cancelling	Only the booker can cancel. The rider's message says to contact the booker for changes
Rating, disputes, lost items	Handled by the booker, who has the account
Someone uses the feature to spam a number	Limit of **10 different rider numbers per booker per day**. The message names the booker, so the rider knows it is not a scam
Children	Riders must be 18 or over unless an adult travels with them (Uber's rule). The booker confirms this when booking
The setting changes while rides are in progress	The setting is saved on each ride at booking, so changes apply only to new bookings
Tracking link after the trip	Expires 1 hour after the trip ends (the existing share-link rule)

OQ-19 — Vehicle Charging & Maintenance: EV-Only, General, or Both?

Recommendation

> **Both, chosen automatically from the vehicle's fuel type.**
>
> - **Every vehicle:** routine service, tyres and brakes check, and the legal papers: insurance, roadworthiness certificate and vehicle licence.
> - **Plug-in vehicles only** (electric and plug-in hybrid): battery health check and charging status.
> - Records belong to the **vehicle**, not the driver, so they stay with the car if it changes hands (common for fleet cars).

Why both: most drivers in Phase 2 will drive petrol or CNG cars, so an EV-only feature would leave most of the fleet without reminders. Expired insurance or roadworthiness papers are a legal and safety risk for every car. Lagos already enforces roadworthiness checks on ride-hailing drivers.

Default intervals (settings)

Item	Applies to	Default	Source of the reading
Routine service	All	Every **5,000 km or 3 months**, whichever comes first	Trip distance E-tiGo records, plus odometer readings the driver or workshop enters at each service
Tyres & brakes check	All	Every **6 months**	Date of the last check
Insurance, roadworthiness, vehicle licence	All	By **expiry date**	Uploaded document, linked to the **vehicle** (today these uploads are linked to the driver; Phase 2 links them to the car)

Item	Applies to	Default	Source of the reading
Battery health check	Electric, plug-in hybrid	Every **12 months**	Workshop record
Charging status	Electric, plug-in hybrid	Live	Charge level the driver enters when going online, plus E-tiGo charging-station sessions. A car-telematics link can come later

Reminders and enforcement

Status	What happens
Due within 14 days	Reminder to the driver (and to operations for fleet cars)
Overdue — service, tyres, battery	Warning only. **Never blocks driving.** Shown to operations
Expired — insurance, roadworthiness, licence	**7-day grace period**, then the driver cannot go online until a new document is approved

Quick options

Option	Scope	When to choose it
A (recommended)	General + EV items, by fuel type	Covers the whole fleet
B	EV only (charging + battery)	If Phase 2 is fleet EVs only. Petrol/CNG drivers get no reminders
C	General only	If E-tiGo has no EVs at launch. EV items can be switched on later

Edge cases and how we handle them

Situation	What happens
Papers expire during a trip	The trip is never interrupted. The block applies the next time the driver tries to go online
A blocked driver holds a scheduled-ride reservation	The reservation is released straight away and the passenger is told, so the booking returns to the pool in time
The driver changes car	The old car's records stay with it; the new car's records apply
The fuel type is corrected (for example petrol → electric)	EV items are added, or archived if the car is no longer plug-in
Non-plug-in hybrid	General items only
An odometer reading goes down	Rejected as a likely typo
Kilometres driven outside E-tiGo	Not visible to us, so the time limit (3 months) still triggers the service
Who updates records	**Fleet cars:** E-tiGo operations. **Own cars:** the driver uploads proof (receipt, certificate), operations approve
A service is booked	Uses the existing repair and maintenance request flow (`REP-` numbers), so there is one workshop process

OQ-20 — Driver Scheduling: Shifts or Availability Planning?

Recommendation

> **Availability planning for all drivers, plus assigned shifts only for E-tiGo fleet cars that two or more drivers share.**
>
> - **Availability planning (all drivers, voluntary).** Drivers can tell E-tiGo when and where they plan to drive this week. There is **no penalty** for changing or skipping a plan, and drivers can **always go online** when they like. Operations use the plans to spot gaps (for example "only 8 drivers planned for Lekki, Friday 6–9 pm") and target incentives.
> - **Fleet shifts (shared fleet cars only).** Operations assign day/night shifts so two drivers can share one car with a clean handover. Operations switch shift mode on per car.

Why: Uber and Bolt do not schedule their drivers; drivers choose when to work. DoorDash lets couriers book time slots voluntarily, but they can still work without one. Forcing shifts on independent drivers would also make them look like employees, which is a legal risk for E-tiGo. A car shared by two drivers is the exception: it needs a timetable so both drivers don't claim it at once.

Quick options

Option	How it works	When to choose it
A (recommended)	Voluntary planning for all; shifts for shared fleet cars only	Keeps drivers independent; still runs shared cars properly
B	Availability planning only, no shifts	If no fleet car is shared between drivers
C	Assigned shifts for all drivers	Only if all drivers become E-tiGo employees. Not recommended for contractors

Shift rules (fleet cars in shift mode)

Rule	Default
Driver can go online	From **15 minutes before** to the end of their own shift
New ride offers stop	**15 minutes before the shift ends**, so the car is returned on time
A trip runs past the shift end	The driver finishes the trip; the next driver is told the car may be a little late
Driver not online 30 minutes after the shift starts	Marked **missed** and operations are alerted to reassign the car. No automatic fine; the fleet agreement decides any consequence
Overlapping shifts on the same car or the same driver	Rejected
Shifts after midnight (for example 22:00–06:00)	Supported. Times are stored as full date-times in Lagos time
Scheduled-ride reservations	A fleet driver in shift mode can only reserve bookings inside their own shifts

Edge cases for availability plans

Situation	What happens
A driver plans hours and doesn't show up	Nothing happens to the driver. The plan is just a forecast

Situation	What happens
Plans shown to passengers	Never. Plans are for operations only and do not promise a passenger a car
Shared fleet car with a driver who also has their own car	Their shifts apply only to the fleet car

OQ-21 — Dispute Escalation Tiers and Ownership

Today every dispute goes to the Support team, and any support admin can refund up to the full fare. Phase 2 adds evidence uploads and escalation.

Recommendation

> **Three tiers, plus specialist routing for safety and payment cases.**

Tier	Owner	Handles	Refund limit per dispute
1	Support agent (existing `support` role)	Every new dispute except safety	Up to **₦5,000**
2	**Support lead** (new admin role)	Escalations, appeals, missed deadlines, repeat offenders, refunds above ₦5,000	Up to **₦50,000**
3	Super admin	Refunds above ₦50,000, permanent driver deactivation, legal, press or regulator cases, final appeals	No limit

Specialist routing	Owner
Safety concerns (assault, harassment, dangerous driving)	Go **straight to the Safety team** (`safety_operator`), skipping tier 1, with a **1-hour** first-response target. Linked to any SOS incident on the trip
Payment errors (double charges, failed refunds, chargebacks)	Support keeps the case; **Finance** must approve any money movement beyond a normal wallet refund
Lost items	Use the Phase 2 Lost & Found flow, not disputes

Why: a three-level ladder (agent, lead, management) is the standard support model. Linking refund limits to tiers keeps small cases fast and puts a second person on large refunds. Safety cases skip the queue because every hour counts.

Response targets (settings)

Tier	First response	Resolution	If missed
Safety	1 hour	24 hours	Alert to super admin
1	24 hours	72 hours	Escalates to tier 2 automatically
2	24 hours	5 days	Alert to super admin

Quick options

Option	Structure	When to choose it
A (recommended)	3 tiers + Safety fast-track, refund limits per tier	Scales with the team; second pair of eyes on large refunds
B	2 tiers (Support → Super admin)	A very small support team. Super admins get more cases
C	Single tier with Safety fast-track	Today's model with only the safety change

Edge cases and how we handle them

Situation	What happens
A refund above the agent's limit	The agent proposes it; it waits for a tier 2 approver. **No one approves their own refund**
Escalating a closed dispute	Not allowed. Closed disputes reopen only through an appeal
Appeals	The passenger or driver can appeal **once, within 7 days** of the decision. The appeal goes up one tier, to a **different** reviewer from the one who decided
An appeal reverses a refund	The driver's earnings are clawed back with the existing refund clawback
Escalating above tier 3	Not possible; tier 3 is final
The assigned admin leaves or is deactivated	Their open disputes go back to their tier's shared queue
Passenger and driver both dispute the same trip	The two disputes are linked and handled by the same owner
Sending a case back down	Allowed (for example tier 2 → tier 1 with instructions); a note is required
Who sees evidence (photos, audio)	Only the assigned reviewer, higher tiers and the Safety team, as Phase 2 requires (NF-12). Every view is audit-logged
What the passenger sees	"Your case is with our senior team", never admin names

OQ-22 — Which Cities, and When?

The target dates are a business decision only the client can make. Engineering's role is to make sure any city can be switched on safely. The current setup (each city has a map boundary, prices, vehicle classes, time zone and currency) already supports more cities without database changes.

Recommendation

> **Launch order: Lagos (launch city) → Abuja → Port Harcourt → Ibadan.** Each city goes live only when it passes the readiness checklist below, not on a fixed date.
>
> Suggested timing for the client to confirm: **Abuja no earlier than 6 weeks after Lagos is stable**, and Port Harcourt in the following quarter.

Why this order: after Lagos, Abuja has the most ride-hailing demand in Nigeria and many business travellers between the two cities. Port Harcourt and Ibadan are large cities where ride-hailing already operates. Launching a city only when it has enough drivers avoids long waits, which put passengers off a new city. The client's own market data should override this order.

City readiness checklist

#	Gate	Default
1	Map boundary drawn, with no overlap with other cities	Required
2	Prices set for every vehicle class offered; surge rules reviewed	Required
3	Approved, KYC-verified drivers in the city	**At least 30**
4	Support and Safety cover for the city's hours	Required
5	State transport permits or registrations, where the state requires them	Client/Legal to confirm per state
6	Charging stations live, if EV classes are offered	Required for EV classes
7	Launch promo codes limited to the city	Optional

Driver-first soft launch

We recommend three city states instead of today's on/off switch:

State	Drivers	Passengers
Onboarding	Can sign up, do KYC and be approved	Cannot book; can join a waitlist
Live	Normal	Normal
Paused	No new trips	Cannot book; trips in progress finish normally

This lets E-tiGo recruit drivers for a few weeks before passengers can book, so the first passengers find cars.

Edge cases and how we handle them

Situation	What happens
A trip from one city ends in another or outside any city	The pickup city's prices apply, and the passenger sees a warning (already built)
A driver moves city	Operations move them. Not allowed while they have an active trip or upcoming reservations
A city is paused with scheduled bookings	**Existing bookings still go ahead by default**; operations can choose to cancel them all with a notice to each passenger
A city is paused while trips are in progress	They finish normally. Today the city switch has no such check, so we will add it
Commuters living outside the city limits (for example Lagos–Ogun: Mowe, Arepo, Ibafo)	We recommend drawing the Lagos boundary to include the commuter belt
Boundaries overlap	Rejected when saved, so a pickup always maps to one city
Time zone and currency	All Nigerian cities use Lagos time and naira, so nothing changes. A city outside Nigeria would need some Lagos-time rules (payout day, promo peak hours) moved to the city's own time zone

OQ-36 and OQ-37 — Lost & Found: Return Fee and Contact Details

Added 18 October 2026, when Lost & Found was built.

Lost & Found follows the Uber, Bolt and Lyft model:

1. The passenger reports the item from the trip, up to **30 days** after it.
2. The driver is notified and says whether they have it.
3. If they do, the two arrange the return through messages in the app.
4. The driver marks the item returned and the passenger confirms.

Support steps in when the passenger asks, when the driver does not answer within **24 hours**, or when the return has not happened within **7 days**. Drivers can also hand in items they find. Two choices need the client.

OQ-36: Should passengers pay a return fee? Uber and Bolt charge the passenger a fee when the driver brings an item back, and the driver keeps all of it. The fee pays for the driver's time and fuel, and it is why drivers return items at all.

Option	What happens
A — Fee of ₦2,000 (recommended)	Charged once the item is back: from the wallet, or as a balance due if the wallet is short. All of it goes to the driver. Support can waive it
B — Another amount	Any amount; operations can change it at any time. A new amount applies only to items found after the change
C — No fee (built default until the client decides)	Drivers return items for free

OQ-37: Do passenger and driver see each other's phone number?

Option	What happens
A — Yes, once the driver has the item (recommended, built default)	Each sees the other's first name and number until the item is back. Messages in the app also work
B — Messages in the app only	No phone numbers are shared. Better for privacy, but returns are slower

The recommendation is A because E-tiGo has no masked calling yet. Once masked calling exists, the apps can use it instead.

Edge cases planned for

Situation	What happens
The lost item is the passenger's phone	The passenger can give another number when reporting. Updates are also sent to it by SMS
The driver says "not found"	The passenger can ask support to look into it. With no follow-up within 7 days, the report closes
The driver later finds it	The driver can change the answer to "found"
The driver says it was returned but the passenger disagrees	The passenger tells support. Otherwise the report closes as resolved after 72 hours
The driver's account is suspended or deleted	The report goes straight to support
A trip booked for someone else	The booker reports it, as for ratings and disputes
Misuse	One open report per trip, and at most 3 open reports per passenger

Next Steps

#	Action	Owner
1	Confirm or change OQ-18 to OQ-21 (pick option A, B or C for each) before Week 9; otherwise the recommended defaults are built	Client / Product
2	Give the target date for each new city, and confirm the driver minimum (30)	Client
3	Confirm the dispute refund limits (₦5,000 / ₦50,000) and who will hold the new Support Lead role	Client / Operations
4	Say which fleet cars are shared between drivers (for shift mode)	Operations
5	Confirm the permits needed in Abuja (FCT) and Rivers State	Legal
6	Lost & Found: choose the return fee (OQ-36) and whether phone numbers are shared (OQ-37)	Client / Product
7	Build Phase 2 to these defaults; any later change is a settings update	Engineering

Sources (public pages; terms vary by market and change over time):

- Uber, booking for someone else: uber.com/ng/en/blog/request-a-ride-for-a-loved-one-today, uber.com/blog/request-a-ride-for-friends-and-loved-ones
- Bolt, rides booked for others (2–6%): citinewsroom.com
- DoorDash, voluntary scheduling for independent couriers: help.doordash.com — New Dasher Guide, dasher.doordash.com — scheduling guide
- Lagos roadworthiness checks on ride-hailing drivers: nairametrics.com
- E-tiGo: Open Questions Decision Report, Scheduled Rides Decisions Report